

sheet or notebook, so that you can refer back to it.

If your debt is on a credit card or 'buy now, pay later' account, where you can keep borrowing more and the amount that you repay each month can be variable, it's much easier to get a bit lost with how much you should be repaying and when. A little more self-discipline is needed, especially if you're susceptible to emotional spending, but making your plan to pay off this kind of debt means making a commitment to limiting, or even eliminating, the use of your credit account while you're repaying the balance. Even if you intend to continue using your account after clearing your debt, which is perfectly fine, you still need a plan for reducing what you owe. Try something like this:

- Calculate how much you can afford to repay each month, making sure that you're still leaving at least a little leeway for enjoyment in your budget. Remember, punitive budgeting doesn't work long term.
- Calculate roughly how long it will take you to repay your debt if you make these repayments each month.
- If you have multiple credit accounts, prioritize them either in order of interest (i.e. how expensive the debt is) or in order of smallest to largest (so that you get those motivating wins early on). Then, focus most of your available funds on the first priority, while still